



SESSION 21

Singular Value Decomposition (SVD)

Full & Truncated SVD · Geometric Transformations · Matrix Approximation · Applications

SVD Definition & Formula

Left & Right Singular Vectors

Singular Values & Diagonal Matrix

Geometric Intuition of SVD

SVD vs Eigendecomposition

Low-Rank Matrix Approximation

Image Compression with SVD

Python SVD Implementation

Session Notes — Complete Reference

Playlist: Maths for Machine Learning · Instructor: Nitish Singh (CampusX)



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01 · SVD Definition & Formula

Singular Value Decomposition (SVD) generalises eigendecomposition to any $m \times n$ matrix:

SVD MATRIX FACTORIZATION

$A = U \cdot \Sigma \cdot V^T$ where: U is $m \times m$ orthogonal matrix (left singular vectors) Σ is $m \times n$ diagonal matrix containing singular values V is $n \times n$ orthogonal matrix (right singular vectors)

02 · Left & Right Singular Vectors

- **Right Singular Vectors (V):** Eigenvectors of the symmetric matrix $A^T A$.
- **Left Singular Vectors (U):** Eigenvectors of the symmetric matrix $A A^T$.

03 · Singular Values & Diagonal Matrix

The diagonal entries of Σ are the **singular values** σ_i , which are the square roots of the eigenvalues of $A^T A$ (or $A A^T$). They are non-negative and sorted in descending order.

04 • Geometric Intuition of SVD

SVD states that any linear transformation can be broken down into three sequential steps: a rotation (V^T), a scaling along the coordinate axes (Σ), and a second rotation (U).

05 · SVD vs Eigendecomposition

FEATURE	EIGENDECOMPOSITION	SVD
Applicability	Square matrices only ($n \times n$)	Any matrix ($m \times n$)
Matrix properties	Not always diagonalizable	Always exists for any real matrix
Orthogonality	Eigenvectors not always orthogonal	Singular vectors are always orthogonal

06 · Low-Rank Matrix Approximation

The **Eckart-Young-Mirsky Theorem** states that we can form the optimal rank- k approximation of a matrix A by keeping only the top k singular values and corresponding vectors: $A_k = \sum_{i=1}^k \sigma_i \mathbf{u}_i \mathbf{v}_i^T$. This is the basis of data compression.

07 • Image Compression with SVD

An image is represented as a matrix. Reconstructing the image using only the top k singular values ($k \leq \min(m, n)$) compresses the image size while retaining most visual details.

08 · Python SVD Implementation

```
import numpy as np

A = np.array([[1, 2], [3, 4], [5, 6]])

U, s, Vt = np.linalg.svd(A)
print("U matrix:
", U)
print("Singular values:", s)
print("V^T matrix:
", Vt)
```

09 · Quick Reference Card



SVD Cheat Sheet

- **Formula:** $A = U \Sigma V^T$.
- **Relationship:** Singular values = $\sqrt{\text{Eigenvalues of } A^T A}$.
- **Low-rank representation:** Drop smaller singular values to filter out noise.